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Air handling unit and method using reinforcement learning model that replicates model predictive control simulation

Abstract

A method includes generating a mixed air temperature value using a reinforcement learning model running on the edge controller. A temperature setpoint and a weather forecast are inputs to the reinforcement learning model. The method also includes controlling damper positions of an air handling unit to achieve the mixed air temperature value.

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Background/Summary

BACKGROUND

(1) The present disclosure relates generally to the field of building equipment, for example building equipment in building management systems (BMSs). A BMS is, in general, a system of devices configured to control, monitor, and manage equipment in or around a building. A BMS can include, for example, a HVAC system, a security system, a lighting system, a fire alerting system, any other system that is capable of managing building functions or devices, or any combination thereof.

(2) A BMS can provide high-level control of building equipment and/or spaces, for example by providing a temperature setpoint for a building or building space, and may use various advanced, computationally-intensive approaches for example to reduce energy usage, improve occupant comfort, etc. Such setpoints can be provided to edge equipment (e.g., air handling units, chillers, variable air volume boxes, etc.). However, control of equipment at the edge (locally at equipment units) to implement such targets from the BMS is typically less sophisticated, for example due to limited computing power and memory available in edge controllers. Improved efficiency could be achieved by better controlling internal equipment parameters such as damper positions, fan speeds,

mixed air temperature, etc. to achieve targets set by a BMS.

SUMMARY

- (3) One implementation of the present disclosure is a method including generating a mixed air temperature value using a reinforcement learning model running on the edge controller. A temperature setpoint and a weather forecast are inputs to the reinforcement learning model. The method also includes controlling damper positions of an air handling unit to achieve the mixed air temperature value.
- (4) In some embodiments, the method also includes automatically updating, by the edge controller, the reinforcement learning model based on a reward function including a difference between the indoor air temperature setpoint and a measured indoor air temperature. In some embodiments, the reward function is further based on an occupancy of a space served by the air handling unit.
- (5) In some embodiments, using the reinforcement learning model includes performing feature generation on streaming input data based on logic in a functional programming language and using variables resulting from the feature generation as inputs to a model. In some embodiments, generating the mixed air temperature value using the reinforcement learning model running on the edge controller also includes processing streams of building and equipment state information at the edge controller.
- (6) In some embodiments, the method also includes creating the reinforcement learning model on a computing system separate from the edge controller and transferring the reinforcement learning model from the computing system to the edge controller after the initial training. Creating the reinforcement learning model may include training the reinforcement learning model to replicate outputs of a model predictive control algorithm running in a simulation.
- (7) In some embodiments, the method includes determining, by the model predictive control algorithm, simulated mixed air temperatures which minimize a simulated objective associated with running a simulated air handling unit in the simulation. In some embodiments, the inputs to the artificial intelligence algorithm also include an occupancy forecast.
- (8) Another implementation of the present disclosure is a method of controlling a unit of building equipment. The method includes receiving a setpoint for a condition of a building space and a measurement of the condition of a building space at an edge controller of a unit of building equipment and generating a control value for an internal parameter of the unit of building equipment by running a reinforcement learning process on the edge controller, which can include reinforcing learning of a model of the reinforcement learning process using the setpoint and the measurement and using the setpoint and the measurement as inputs to the model for generating the control value. The method can also include controlling, by the edge controller, the unit of building equipment in accordance with the control value.
- (9) In some embodiments, the method includes performing initial training of the model at a computing system separate from the edge controller and providing the model from the computing system to the edge controller after the initial training. Performing the initial training of the model can include training the artificial intelligence algorithm to replicate outputs of a model predictive control algorithm running in a simulation. Performing the initial training of the model can include determining, by running a simulation, simulated mixed air temperatures which minimize a simulated objective associated with running a simulated version of the unit of building equipment.
- (10) In some embodiments, the inputs to the model for generating the control value also include an occupancy forecast. In some embodiments, the inputs to the model also include values for a plurality of state variables corresponding to states of the unit of building equipment or the building space. In some embodiments, reinforcing learning of the model using the setpoint and the measurement includes updating the model based on a reward function. The reward function can include a difference between setpoint and the measurement. The reward function may also account for an amount of consumption associated with operating the unit of building equipment.
- (11) In some embodiments, an air handling unit includes a plurality of dampers and a local

controller programmed to control the plurality of dampers by generating a mixed air temperature value using an reinforcement learning model running on the controller and controlling damper positions of an air handling unit to achieve the mixed air temperature value. Inputs to the reinforcement learning model can include a temperature setpoint and a weather forecast.

(12) In some embodiments, the local controller is also programmed to automatically update the reinforcement learning model using reinforcement learning based on a difference between an indoor temperature setpoint for a building served by the air handling unit and a measurement of the indoor temperature setpoint. In some embodiments, the mixed air temperature value is a change in mixed air temperature of the air handling unit to be achieved by controlling the damper positions.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) Various objects, aspects, features, and advantages of the disclosure will become more apparent and better understood by referring to the detailed description taken in conjunction with the accompanying drawings, in which like reference characters identify corresponding elements throughout. In the drawings, like reference numbers generally indicate identical, functionally similar, and/or structurally similar elements.

(2) FIG. 1 is a drawing of a building equipped with a HVAC system, according to some embodiments.

(3) FIG. 2 is a block diagram of a waterside system that may be used in conjunction with the building of FIG. 1, according to some embodiments.

(4) FIG. 3 is a block diagram of an airside system that may be used in conjunction with the building of FIG. 1, according to some embodiments.

(5) FIG. 4 is a block diagram of a building management system (BMS) that may be used to monitor and/or control the building of FIG. 1, according to some embodiments.

(6) FIG. 5 is a block diagram of another BMS which can be used to monitor and control the building of FIG. 1, according to some embodiments.

(7) FIG. 6 is a block diagram of a control system for building equipment, according to some embodiments.

(8) FIG. 7 is a block diagram showing an edge controller of the control system of FIG. 6, according to some embodiments.

(9) FIG. 8 is a flowchart of a control process executable by the control system of FIG. 6, according to some embodiments.

(10) FIG. 9 is a graphical representation of experimental data showing results provided by the control system of FIG. 6, according to some embodiments.

(11) FIG. 10 is a graphical representation of experimental data showing additional results provided by the control system of FIG. 6, according to some embodiments.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(12) Building HVAC Systems and Building Management Systems

(13) Referring now to FIGS. 1-5, several building management systems (BMS) and HVAC systems in which the systems and methods of the present disclosure can be implemented are shown, according to some embodiments. In brief overview, FIG. 1 shows a building 10 equipped with a HVAC system 100. FIG. 2 is a block diagram of a waterside system 200 which can be used to serve building 10. FIG. 3 is a block diagram of an airside system 300 which can be used to serve building 10. FIG. 4 is a block diagram of a BMS which can be used to monitor and control building 10. FIG. 5 is a block diagram of another BMS which can be used to monitor and control building 10.

(14) Referring particularly to FIG. 1, a perspective view of a building 10 is shown. Building 10 is served by a BMS. A BMS is, in general, a system of devices configured to control, monitor, and

manage equipment in or around a building or building area. A BMS can include, for example, a HVAC system, a security system, a lighting system, a fire safety system, any other system that is capable of managing building functions or devices, or any combination thereof.

(15) The BMS that serves building **10** includes an HVAC system **100**. HVAC system **100** can include a plurality of HVAC devices (e.g., heaters, chillers, air handling units, pumps, fans, thermal energy storage, etc.) configured to provide heating, cooling, ventilation, or other services for building **10**. For example, HVAC system **100** is shown to include a waterside system **120** and an airside system **130**. Waterside system **120** can provide a heated or chilled fluid to an air handling unit of airside system **130**. Airside system **130** can use the heated or chilled fluid to heat or cool an airflow provided to building **10**. An exemplary waterside system and airside system which can be used in HVAC system **100** are described in greater detail with reference to FIGS. 2-3.

(16) HVAC system **100** is shown to include a chiller **102**, a boiler **104**, and a rooftop air handling unit (AHU) **106**. Waterside system **120** can use boiler **104** and chiller **102** to heat or cool a working fluid (e.g., water, glycol, etc.) and can circulate the working fluid to AHU **106**. In various embodiments, the HVAC devices of waterside system **120** can be located in or around building **10** (as shown in FIG. 1) or at an offsite location such as a central plant (e.g., a chiller plant, a steam plant, a heat plant, etc.). The working fluid can be heated in boiler **104** or cooled in chiller **102**, depending on whether heating or cooling is required in building **10**. Boiler **104** can add heat to the circulated fluid, for example, by burning a combustible material (e.g., natural gas) or using an electric heating element. Chiller **102** can place the circulated fluid in a heat exchange relationship with another fluid (e.g., a refrigerant) in a heat exchanger (e.g., an evaporator) to absorb heat from the circulated fluid. The working fluid from chiller **102** and/or boiler **104** can be transported to AHU **106** via piping **108**.

(17) AHU **106** can place the working fluid in a heat exchange relationship with an airflow passing through AHU **106** (e.g., via one or more stages of cooling coils and/or heating coils). The airflow can be, for example, outside air, return air from within building **10**, or a combination of both. AHU **106** can transfer heat between the airflow and the working fluid to provide heating or cooling for the airflow. For example, AHU **106** can include one or more fans or blowers configured to pass the airflow over or through a heat exchanger containing the working fluid. The working fluid can then return to chiller **102** or boiler **104** via piping **110**.

(18) Airside system **130** can deliver the airflow supplied by AHU **106** (i.e., the supply airflow) to building **10** via air supply ducts **112** and can provide return air from building **10** to AHU **106** via air return ducts **114**. In some embodiments, airside system **130** includes multiple variable air volume (VAV) units **116**. For example, airside system **130** is shown to include a separate VAV unit **116** on each floor or zone of building **10**. VAV units **116** can include dampers or other flow control elements that can be operated to control an amount of the supply airflow provided to individual zones of building **10**. In other embodiments, airside system **130** delivers the supply airflow into one or more zones of building **10** (e.g., via supply ducts **112**) without using intermediate VAV units **116** or other flow control elements. AHU **106** can include various sensors (e.g., temperature sensors, pressure sensors, etc.) configured to measure attributes of the supply airflow. AHU **106** can receive input from sensors located within AHU **106** and/or within the building zone and can adjust the flow rate, temperature, or other attributes of the supply airflow through AHU **106** to achieve setpoint conditions for the building zone.

(19) In FIG. 2, waterside system **200** is shown as a central plant having a plurality of subplants **202-212**. Subplants **202-212** are shown to include a heater subplant **202**, a heat recovery chiller subplant **204**, a chiller subplant **206**, a cooling tower subplant **208**, a hot thermal energy storage (TES) subplant **210**, and a cold thermal energy storage (TES) subplant **212**. Subplants **202-212** consume resources (e.g., water, natural gas, electricity, etc.) from utilities to serve the thermal energy loads (e.g., hot water, cold water, heating, cooling, etc.) of a building or campus. For example, heater subplant **202** may be configured to heat water in a hot water loop **214** that

circulates the hot water between heater subplant **202** and building **10**. Chiller subplant **206** may be configured to chill water in a cold water loop **216** that circulates the cold water between chiller subplant **206** building **10**. Heat recovery chiller subplant **204** may be configured to transfer heat from cold water loop **216** to hot water loop **214** to provide additional heating for the hot water and additional cooling for the cold water. Condenser water loop **218** may absorb heat from the cold water in chiller subplant **206** and reject the absorbed heat in cooling tower subplant **208** or transfer the absorbed heat to hot water loop **214**. Hot TES subplant **210** and cold TES subplant **212** may store hot and cold thermal energy, respectively, for subsequent use.

(20) Hot water loop **214** and cold water loop **216** may deliver the heated and/or chilled water to air handlers located on the rooftop of building **10** (e.g., AHU **106**) or to individual floors or zones of building **10** (e.g., VAV units **116**). The air handlers push air past heat exchangers (e.g., heating coils or cooling coils) through which the water flows to provide heating or cooling for the air. The heated or cooled air may be delivered to individual zones of building **10** to serve the thermal energy loads of building **10**. The water then returns to subplants **202-212** to receive further heating or cooling.

(21) Although subplants **202-212** are shown and described as heating and cooling water for circulation to a building, it is understood that any other type of working fluid (e.g., glycol, CO₂, etc.) may be used in place of or in addition to water to serve the thermal energy loads. In other embodiments, subplants **202-212** may provide heating and/or cooling directly to the building or campus without requiring an intermediate heat transfer fluid. These and other variations to waterside system **200** are within the teachings of the present invention.

(22) Each of subplants **202-212** may include a variety of equipment configured to facilitate the functions of the subplant. For example, heater subplant **202** is shown to include a plurality of heating elements **220** (e.g., boilers, electric heaters, etc.) configured to add heat to the hot water in hot water loop **214**. Heater subplant **202** is also shown to include several pumps **222** and **224** configured to circulate the hot water in hot water loop **214** and to control the flow rate of the hot water through individual heating elements **220**. Chiller subplant **206** is shown to include a plurality of chillers **232** configured to remove heat from the cold water in cold water loop **216**. Chiller subplant **206** is also shown to include several pumps **234** and **236** configured to circulate the cold water in cold water loop **216** and to control the flow rate of the cold water through individual chillers **232**.

(23) Heat recovery chiller subplant **204** is shown to include a plurality of heat recovery heat exchangers **226** (e.g., refrigeration circuits) configured to transfer heat from cold water loop **216** to hot water loop **214**. Heat recovery chiller subplant **204** is also shown to include several pumps **228** and **230** configured to circulate the hot water and/or cold water through heat recovery heat exchangers **226** and to control the flow rate of the water through individual heat recovery heat exchangers **226**. Cooling tower subplant **208** is shown to include a plurality of cooling towers **238** configured to remove heat from the condenser water in condenser water loop **218**. Cooling tower subplant **208** is also shown to include several pumps **240** configured to circulate the condenser water in condenser water loop **218** and to control the flow rate of the condenser water through individual cooling towers **238**.

(24) Hot TES subplant **210** is shown to include a hot TES tank **242** configured to store the hot water for later use. Hot TES subplant **210** may also include one or more pumps or valves configured to control the flow rate of the hot water into or out of hot TES tank **242**. Cold TES subplant **212** is shown to include cold TES tanks **244** configured to store the cold water for later use. Cold TES subplant **212** may also include one or more pumps or valves configured to control the flow rate of the cold water into or out of cold TES tanks **244**.

(25) In some embodiments, one or more of the pumps in waterside system **200** (e.g., pumps **222**, **224**, **228**, **230**, **234**, **236**, and/or **240**) or pipelines in waterside system **200** include an isolation valve associated therewith. Isolation valves may be integrated with the pumps or positioned upstream or downstream of the pumps to control the fluid flows in waterside system **200**. In

various embodiments, waterside system **200** may include more, fewer, or different types of devices and/or subplants Based on the particular configuration of waterside system **200** and the types of loads served by waterside system **200**.

(26) Referring now to FIG. **3**, a block diagram of an airside system **300** is shown, according to some embodiments. In various embodiments, airside system **300** may supplement or replace airside system **130** in HVAC system **100** or may be implemented separate from HVAC system **100**. When implemented in HVAC system **100**, airside system **300** may include a subset of the HVAC devices in HVAC system **100** (e.g., AHU **106**, VAV units **116**, ducts **112-114**, fans, dampers, etc.) and may be located in or around building **10**. Airside system **300** may operate to heat or cool an airflow provided to building **10** using a heated or chilled fluid provided by waterside system **200**.

(27) In FIG. **3**, airside system **300** is shown to include an economizer-type air handling unit (AHU) **302**. Economizer-type AHUs vary the amount of outside air and return air used by the air handling unit for heating or cooling. For example, AHU **302** may receive return air **304** from building zone **306** via return air duct **308** and may deliver supply air **310** to building zone **306** via supply air duct **312**. In some embodiments, AHU **302** is a rooftop unit located on the roof of building **10** (e.g., AHU **106** as shown in FIG. **1**) or otherwise positioned to receive both return air **304** and outside air **314**. AHU **302** may be configured to operate exhaust air damper **316**, mixing damper **318**, and outside air damper **320** to control an amount of outside air **314** and return air **304** that combine to form supply air **310**. Any return air **304** that does not pass through mixing damper **318** may be exhausted from AHU **302** through exhaust damper **316** as exhaust air **322**.

(28) Each of dampers **316-320** may be operated by an actuator. For example, exhaust air damper **316** may be operated by actuator **324**, mixing damper **318** may be operated by actuator **326**, and outside air damper **320** may be operated by actuator **328**. Actuators **324-328** may communicate with an AHU controller **330** via a communications link **332**. Actuators **324-328** may receive control signals from AHU controller **330** and may provide feedback signals to AHU controller **330**. Feedback signals may include, for example, an indication of a current actuator or damper position, an amount of torque or force exerted by the actuator, diagnostic information (e.g., results of diagnostic tests performed by actuators **324-328**), status information, commissioning information, configuration settings, calibration data, and/or other types of information or data that may be collected, stored, or used by actuators **324-328**. AHU controller **330** may be an economizer controller configured to use one or more control algorithms (e.g., state-Based algorithms, extremum seeking control (ESC) algorithms, proportional-integral (PI) control algorithms, proportional-integral-derivative (PID) control algorithms, model predictive control (MPC) algorithms, feedback control algorithms, etc.) to control actuators **324-328**.

(29) Still referring to FIG. **3**, AHU **302** is shown to include a cooling coil **334**, a heating coil **336**, and a fan **338** positioned within supply air duct **312**. Fan **338** may be configured to force supply air **310** through cooling coil **334** and/or heating coil **336** and provide supply air **310** to building zone **306**. AHU controller **330** may communicate with fan **338** via communications link **340** to control a flow rate of supply air **310**. In some embodiments, AHU controller **330** controls an amount of heating or cooling applied to supply air **310** by modulating a speed of fan **338**.

(30) Cooling coil **334** may receive a chilled fluid from waterside system **200** (e.g., from cold water loop **216**) via piping **342** and may return the chilled fluid to waterside system **200** via piping **344**. Valve **346** may be positioned along piping **342** or piping **344** to control a flow rate of the chilled fluid through cooling coil **334**. In some embodiments, cooling coil **334** includes multiple stages of cooling coils that can be independently activated and deactivated (e.g., by AHU controller **330**, by BMS controller **366**, etc.) to modulate an amount of cooling applied to supply air **310**.

(31) Heating coil **336** may receive a heated fluid from waterside system **200** (e.g., from hot water loop **214**) via piping **348** and may return the heated fluid to waterside system **200** via piping **350**. Valve **352** may be positioned along piping **348** or piping **350** to control a flow rate of the heated fluid through heating coil **336**. In some embodiments, heating coil **336** includes multiple stages of

heating coils that can be independently activated and deactivated (e.g., by AHU controller **330**, by BMS controller **366**, etc.) to modulate an amount of heating applied to supply air **310**.

(32) Each of valves **346** and **352** may be controlled by an actuator. For example, valve **346** may be controlled by actuator **354** and valve **352** may be controlled by actuator **356**. Actuators **354-356** may communicate with AHU controller **330** via communications links **358-360**. Actuators **354-356** may receive control signals from AHU controller **330** and may provide feedback signals to controller **330**. In some embodiments, AHU controller **330** receives a measurement of the supply air temperature from a temperature sensor **362** positioned in supply air duct **312** (e.g., downstream of cooling coil **334** and/or heating coil **336**). AHU controller **330** may also receive a measurement of the temperature of building zone **306** from a temperature sensor **364** located in building zone **306**. AHU controller **330** may also receive a measurement of a mixed air temperature from a temperature sensor **361** positioned upstream of cooling coil **334** and heating coil **336** and downstream of dampers **320, 318**.

(33) In some embodiments, AHU controller **330** operates valves **346** and **352** via actuators **354-356** to modulate an amount of heating or cooling provided to supply air **310** (e.g., to achieve a setpoint temperature for supply air **310** or to maintain the temperature of supply air **310** within a setpoint temperature range). The positions of valves **346** and **352** affect the amount of heating or cooling provided to supply air **310** by cooling coil **334** or heating coil **336** and may correlate with the amount of energy consumed to achieve a desired supply air temperature. AHU controller **330** may control the temperature of supply air **310** and/or building zone **306** by activating or deactivating coils **334-336**, adjusting a speed of fan **338**, or a combination of both.

(34) Still referring to FIG. **3**, airside system **300** is shown to include a building management system (BMS) controller **366** and a client device **368**. BMS controller **366** may include one or more computer systems (e.g., servers, supervisory controllers, subsystem controllers, etc.) that serve as system level controllers, application or data servers, head nodes, or master controllers for airside system **300**, waterside system **200**, HVAC system **100**, and/or other controllable systems that serve building **10**. BMS controller **366** may communicate with multiple downstream building systems or subsystems (e.g., HVAC system **100**, a security system, a lighting system, waterside system **200**, etc.) via a communications link **370** according to like or disparate protocols (e.g., LON, BACnet, etc.). In various embodiments, AHU controller **330** and BMS controller **366** may be separate (as shown in FIG. **3**) or integrated. In an integrated implementation, AHU controller **330** may be a software module configured for execution by a processor of BMS controller **366**.

(35) In some embodiments, AHU controller **330** receives information from BMS controller **366** (e.g., commands, setpoints, operating boundaries, etc.) and provides information to BMS controller **366** (e.g., temperature measurements, valve or actuator positions, operating statuses, diagnostics, etc.). For example, AHU controller **330** may provide BMS controller **366** with temperature measurements from temperature sensors **362-364**, equipment on/off states, equipment operating capacities, and/or any other information that can be used by BMS controller **366** to monitor or control a variable state or condition within building zone **306**.

(36) Client device **368** may include one or more human-machine interfaces or client interfaces (e.g., graphical user interfaces, reporting interfaces, text-Based computer interfaces, client-facing web services, web servers that provide pages to web clients, etc.) for controlling, viewing, or otherwise interacting with HVAC system **100**, its subsystems, and/or devices. Client device **368** may be a computer workstation, a client terminal, a remote or local interface, or any other type of user interface device. Client device **368** may be a stationary terminal or a mobile device. For example, client device **368** may be a desktop computer, a computer server with a user interface, a laptop computer, a tablet, a smartphone, a PDA, or any other type of mobile or non-mobile device. Client device **368** may communicate with BMS controller **366** and/or AHU controller **330** via communications link **372**.

(37) Referring now to FIG. **4**, a block diagram of a building management system (BMS) **400** is

shown, according to some embodiments. BMS **400** may be implemented in building **10** to automatically monitor and control various building functions. BMS **400** is shown to include BMS controller **366** and a plurality of building subsystems **428**. Building subsystems **428** are shown to include a building electrical subsystem **434**, an information communication technology (ICT) subsystem **436**, a security subsystem **438**, a HVAC subsystem **440**, a lighting subsystem **442**, a lift/escalators subsystem **432**, and a fire safety subsystem **430**. In various embodiments, building subsystems **428** can include fewer, additional, or alternative subsystems. For example, building subsystems **428** may also or alternatively include a refrigeration subsystem, an advertising or signage subsystem, a cooking subsystem, a vending subsystem, a printer or copy service subsystem, or any other type of building subsystem that uses controllable equipment and/or sensors to monitor or control building **10**. In some embodiments, building subsystems **428** include waterside system **200** and/or airside system **300**, as described with reference to FIGS. 2-3.

(38) Each of building subsystems **428** may include any number of devices, controllers, and connections for completing its individual functions and control activities. HVAC subsystem **440** may include many of the same components as HVAC system **100**, as described with reference to FIGS. 1-3. For example, HVAC subsystem **440** may include a chiller, a boiler, any number of air handling units, economizers, field controllers, supervisory controllers, actuators, temperature sensors, and other devices for controlling the temperature, humidity, airflow, or other variable conditions within building **10**. Lighting subsystem **442** may include any number of light fixtures, ballasts, lighting sensors, dimmers, or other devices configured to controllably adjust the amount of light provided to a building space. Security subsystem **438** may include occupancy sensors, video surveillance cameras, digital video recorders, video processing servers, intrusion detection devices, access control devices and servers, or other security-related devices.

(39) Still referring to FIG. 4, BMS controller **366** is shown to include a communications interface **407** and a BMS interface **409**. Interface **407** may facilitate communications between BMS controller **366** and external applications (e.g., monitoring and reporting applications **422**, enterprise control applications **426**, remote systems and applications **444**, applications residing on client devices **448**, etc.) for allowing user control, monitoring, and adjustment to BMS controller **366** and/or subsystems **428**. Interface **407** may also facilitate communications between BMS controller **366** and client devices **448**. BMS interface **409** may facilitate communications between BMS controller **366** and building subsystems **428** (e.g., HVAC, lighting security, lifts, power distribution, business, etc.).

(40) Interfaces **407**, **409** can be or include wired or wireless communications interfaces (e.g., jacks, antennas, transmitters, receivers, transceivers, wire terminals, etc.) for conducting data communications with building subsystems **428** or other external systems or devices. In various embodiments, communications via interfaces **407**, **409** may be direct (e.g., local wired or wireless communications) or via a communications network **446** (e.g., a WAN, the Internet, a cellular network, etc.). For example, interfaces **407**, **409** can include an Ethernet card and port for sending and receiving data via an Ethernet-Based communications link or network. In another example, interfaces **407**, **409** can include a WiFi transceiver for communicating via a wireless communications network. In another example, one or both of interfaces **407**, **409** may include cellular or mobile phone communications transceivers. In one embodiment, communications interface **407** is a power line communications interface and BMS interface **409** is an Ethernet interface. In other embodiments, both communications interface **407** and BMS interface **409** are Ethernet interfaces or are the same Ethernet interface.

(41) Still referring to FIG. 4, BMS controller **366** is shown to include a processing circuit **404** including a processor **406** and memory **408**. Processing circuit **404** may be communicably connected to BMS interface **409** and/or communications interface **407** such that processing circuit **404** and the various components thereof can send and receive data via interfaces **407**, **409**. Processor **406** can be implemented as a general purpose processor, an application specific

integrated circuit (ASIC), one or more field programmable gate arrays (FPGAs), a group of processing components, or other suitable electronic processing components.

(42) Memory **408** (e.g., memory, memory unit, storage device, etc.) may include one or more devices (e.g., RAM, ROM, Flash memory, hard disk storage, etc.) for storing data and/or computer code for completing or facilitating the various processes, layers and modules described in the present application. Memory **408** may be or include volatile memory or non-volatile memory. Memory **408** may include database components, object code components, script components, or any other type of information structure for supporting the various activities and information structures described in the present application. According to an exemplary embodiment, memory **408** is communicably connected to processor **406** via processing circuit **404** and includes computer code for executing (e.g., by processing circuit **404** and/or processor **406**) one or more processes described herein.

(43) In some embodiments, BMS controller **366** is implemented within a single computer (e.g., one server, one housing, etc.). In various other embodiments BMS controller **366** may be distributed across multiple servers or computers (e.g., that can exist in distributed locations). Further, while FIG. **4** shows applications **422** and **426** as existing outside of BMS controller **366**, in some embodiments, applications **422** and **426** may be hosted within BMS controller **366** (e.g., within memory **408**).

(44) Still referring to FIG. **4**, memory **408** is shown to include an enterprise integration layer **410**, an automated measurement and validation (AM&V) layer **412**, a demand response (DR) layer **414**, a fault detection and diagnostics (FDD) layer **416**, an integrated control layer **418**, and a building subsystem integration layer **420**. Layers **410-420** may be configured to receive inputs from building subsystems **428** and other data sources, determine optimal control actions for building subsystems **428**. Based on the inputs, generate control signals Based on the optimal control actions, and provide the generated control signals to building subsystems **428**. The following paragraphs describe some of the general functions performed by each of layers **410-420** in BMS **400**.

(45) Enterprise integration layer **410** may be configured to serve clients or local applications with information and services to support a variety of enterprise-level applications. For example, enterprise control applications **426** may be configured to provide subsystem-spanning control to a graphical user interface (GUI) or to any number of enterprise-level business applications (e.g., accounting systems, user identification systems, etc.). Enterprise control applications **426** may also or alternatively be configured to provide configuration GUIs for configuring BMS controller **366**. In yet other embodiments, enterprise control applications **426** can work with layers **410-420** to optimize building performance (e.g., efficiency, energy use, comfort, or safety) Based on inputs received at interface **407** and/or BMS interface **409**.

(46) Building subsystem integration layer **420** may be configured to manage communications between BMS controller **366** and building subsystems **428**. For example, building subsystem integration layer **420** may receive sensor data and input signals from building subsystems **428** and provide output data and control signals to building subsystems **428**. Building subsystem integration layer **420** may also be configured to manage communications between building subsystems **428**. Building subsystem integration layer **420** translate communications (e.g., sensor data, input signals, output signals, etc.) across a plurality of multi-vendor/multi-protocol systems.

(47) Demand response layer **414** may be configured to optimize resource usage (e.g., electricity use, natural gas use, water use, etc.) and/or the monetary cost of such resource usage in response to satisfy the demand of building **10**. The optimization may be Based on time-of-use prices, curtailment signals, energy availability, or other data received from utility providers, distributed energy generation systems **424**, from energy storage **427** (e.g., hot TES **242**, cold TES **244**, etc.), or from other sources. Demand response layer **414** may receive inputs from other layers of BMS controller **366** (e.g., building subsystem integration layer **420**, integrated control layer **418**, etc.). The inputs received from other layers may include environmental or sensor inputs such as

temperature, carbon dioxide levels, relative humidity levels, air quality sensor outputs, occupancy sensor outputs, room schedules, and the like. The inputs may also include inputs such as electrical use (e.g., expressed in kWh), thermal load measurements, pricing information, projected pricing, smoothed pricing, curtailment signals from utilities, and the like.

(48) According to an exemplary embodiment, demand response layer **414** includes control logic for responding to the data and signals it receives. These responses can include communicating with the control algorithms in integrated control layer **418**, changing control strategies, changing setpoints, or activating/deactivating building equipment or subsystems in a controlled manner. Demand response layer **414** may also include control logic configured to determine when to utilize stored energy. For example, demand response layer **414** may determine to begin using energy from energy storage **427** just prior to the beginning of a peak use hour.

(49) In some embodiments, demand response layer **414** includes a control module configured to actively initiate control actions (e.g., automatically changing setpoints) which minimize energy costs Based on one or more inputs representative of or Based on demand (e.g., price, a curtailment signal, a demand level, etc.). In some embodiments, demand response layer **414** uses equipment models to determine an optimal set of control actions. The equipment models may include, for example, thermodynamic models describing the inputs, outputs, and/or functions performed by various sets of building equipment. Equipment models may represent collections of building equipment (e.g., subplants, chiller arrays, etc.) or individual devices (e.g., individual chillers, heaters, pumps, etc.).

(50) Demand response layer **414** may further include or draw upon one or more demand response policy definitions (e.g., databases, XML, files, etc.). The policy definitions may be edited or adjusted by a user (e.g., via a graphical user interface) so that the control actions initiated in response to demand inputs may be tailored for the user's application, desired comfort level, particular building equipment, or Based on other concerns. For example, the demand response policy definitions can specify which equipment may be turned on or off in response to particular demand inputs, how long a system or piece of equipment should be turned off, what setpoints can be changed, what the allowable set point adjustment range is, how long to hold a high demand setpoint before returning to a normally scheduled setpoint, how close to approach capacity limits, which equipment modes to utilize, the energy transfer rates (e.g., the maximum rate, an alarm rate, other rate boundary information, etc.) into and out of energy storage devices (e.g., thermal storage tanks, battery banks, etc.), and when to dispatch on-site generation of energy (e.g., via fuel cells, a motor generator set, etc.).

(51) Integrated control layer **418** may be configured to use the data input or output of building subsystem integration layer **420** and/or demand response later **414** to make control decisions. Due to the subsystem integration provided by building subsystem integration layer **420**, integrated control layer **418** can integrate control activities of the subsystems **428** such that the subsystems **428** behave as a single integrated super-system. In an exemplary embodiment, integrated control layer **418** includes control logic that uses inputs and outputs from a plurality of building subsystems to provide greater comfort and energy savings relative to the comfort and energy savings that separate subsystems could provide alone. For example, integrated control layer **418** may be configured to use an input from a first subsystem to make an energy-saving control decision for a second subsystem. Results of these decisions can be communicated back to building subsystem integration layer **420**.

(52) Integrated control layer **418** is shown to be logically below demand response layer **414**. Integrated control layer **418** may be configured to enhance the effectiveness of demand response layer **414** by enabling building subsystems **428** and their respective control loops to be controlled in coordination with demand response layer **414**. This configuration may advantageously reduce disruptive demand response behavior relative to conventional systems. For example, integrated control layer **418** may be configured to assure that a demand response-driven upward adjustment to

the setpoint for chilled water temperature (or another component that directly or indirectly affects temperature) does not result in an increase in fan energy (or other energy used to cool a space) that would result in greater total building energy use than was saved at the chiller.

(53) Integrated control layer **418** may be configured to provide feedback to demand response layer **414** so that demand response layer **414** checks that constraints (e.g., temperature, lighting levels, etc.) are properly maintained even while demanded load shedding is in progress. The constraints may also include setpoint or sensed boundaries relating to safety, equipment operating limits and performance, comfort, fire codes, electrical codes, energy codes, and the like. Integrated control layer **418** is also logically below fault detection and diagnostics layer **416** and automated measurement and validation layer **412**. Integrated control layer **418** may be configured to provide calculated inputs (e.g., aggregations) to these higher levels Based on outputs from more than one building subsystem.

(54) Automated measurement and validation (AM&V) layer **412** may be configured to verify that control strategies commanded by integrated control layer **418** or demand response layer **414** are working properly (e.g., using data aggregated by AM&V layer **412**, integrated control layer **418**, building subsystem integration layer **420**, FDD layer **416**, or otherwise). The calculations made by AM&V layer **412** may be based on building system energy models and/or equipment models for individual BMS devices or subsystems. For example, AM&V layer **412** may compare a model-predicted output with an actual output from building subsystems **428** to determine an accuracy of the model.

(55) Fault detection and diagnostics (FDD) layer **416** may be configured to provide on-going fault detection for building subsystems **428**, building subsystem devices (i.e., building equipment), and control algorithms used by demand response layer **414** and integrated control layer **418**. FDD layer **416** may receive data inputs from integrated control layer **418**, directly from one or more building subsystems or devices, or from another data source. FDD layer **416** may automatically diagnose and respond to detected faults. The responses to detected or diagnosed faults may include providing an alert message to a user, a maintenance scheduling system, or a control algorithm configured to attempt to repair the fault or to work-around the fault.

(56) FDD layer **416** may be configured to output a specific identification of the faulty component or cause of the fault (e.g., loose damper linkage) using detailed subsystem inputs available at building subsystem integration layer **420**. In other exemplary embodiments, FDD layer **416** is configured to provide “fault” events to integrated control layer **418** which executes control strategies and policies in response to the received fault events. According to an exemplary embodiment, FDD layer **416** (or a policy executed by an integrated control engine or business rules engine) may shut-down systems or direct control activities around faulty devices or systems to reduce energy waste, extend equipment life, or assure proper control response.

(57) FDD layer **416** may be configured to store or access a variety of different system data stores (or data points for live data). FDD layer **416** may use some content of the data stores to identify faults at the equipment level (e.g., specific chiller, specific AHU, specific terminal unit, etc.) and other content to identify faults at component or subsystem levels. For example, building subsystems **428** may generate temporal (i.e., time-series) data indicating the performance of BMS **400** and the various components thereof. The data generated by building subsystems **428** may include measured or calculated values that exhibit statistical characteristics and provide information about how the corresponding system or process (e.g., a temperature control process, a flow control process, etc.) is performing in terms of error from its setpoint. These processes can be examined by FDD layer **416** to expose when the system begins to degrade in performance and alert a user to repair the fault before it becomes more severe.

(58) Referring now to FIG. 5, a block diagram of another building management system (BMS) **500** is shown, according to some embodiments. BMS **500** can be used to monitor and control the devices of HVAC system **100**, waterside system **200**, airside system **300**, building subsystems **428**,

as well as other types of BMS devices (e.g., lighting equipment, security equipment, etc.) and/or HVAC equipment.

(59) BMS **500** provides a system architecture that facilitates automatic equipment discovery and equipment model distribution. Equipment discovery can occur on multiple levels of BMS **500** across multiple different communications busses (e.g., a system bus **554**, zone buses **556-560** and **564**, sensor/actuator bus **566**, etc.) and across multiple different communications protocols. In some embodiments, equipment discovery is accomplished using active node tables, which provide status information for devices connected to each communications bus. For example, each communications bus can be monitored for new devices by monitoring the corresponding active node table for new nodes. When a new device is detected, BMS **500** can begin interacting with the new device (e.g., sending control signals, using data from the device) without user interaction.

(60) Some devices in BMS **500** present themselves to the network using equipment models. An equipment model defines equipment object attributes, view definitions, schedules, trends, and the associated BACnet value objects (e.g., analog value, binary value, multistate value, etc.) that are used for integration with other systems. Some devices in BMS **500** store their own equipment models. Other devices in BMS **500** have equipment models stored externally (e.g., within other devices). For example, a zone coordinator **508** can store the equipment model for a bypass damper **528**. In some embodiments, zone coordinator **508** automatically creates the equipment model for bypass damper **528** or other devices on zone bus **558**. Other zone coordinators can also create equipment models for devices connected to their zone busses. The equipment model for a device can be created automatically based on the types of data points exposed by the device on the zone bus, device type, and/or other device attributes. Several examples of automatic equipment discovery and equipment model distribution are discussed in greater detail below.

(61) Still referring to FIG. 5, BMS **500** is shown to include a system manager **502**; several zone coordinators **506**, **508**, **510** and **518**; and several zone controllers **524**, **530**, **532**, **536**, **548**, and **550**. System manager **502** can monitor data points in BMS **500** and report monitored variables to various monitoring and/or control applications. System manager **502** can communicate with client devices **504** (e.g., user devices, desktop computers, laptop computers, mobile devices, etc.) via a data communications link **574** (e.g., BACnet IP, Ethernet, wired or wireless communications, etc.). System manager **502** can provide a user interface to client devices **504** via data communications link **574**. The user interface may allow users to monitor and/or control BMS **500** via client devices **504**.

(62) In some embodiments, system manager **502** is connected with zone coordinators **506-510** and **518** via a system bus **554**. System manager **502** can be configured to communicate with zone coordinators **506-510** and **518** via system bus **554** using a master-slave token passing (MSTP) protocol or any other communications protocol. System bus **554** can also connect system manager **502** with other devices such as a constant volume (CV) rooftop unit (RTU) **512**, an input/output module (IOM) **514**, a thermostat controller **516** (e.g., a TEC5000 series thermostat controller), and a network automation engine (NAE) or third-party controller **520**. RTU **512** can be configured to communicate directly with system manager **502** and can be connected directly to system bus **554**. Other RTUs can communicate with system manager **502** via an intermediate device. For example, a wired input **562** can connect a third-party RTU **542** to thermostat controller **516**, which connects to system bus **554**.

(63) System manager **502** can provide a user interface for any device containing an equipment model. Devices such as zone coordinators **506-510** and **518** and thermostat controller **516** can provide their equipment models to system manager **502** via system bus **554**. In some embodiments, system manager **502** automatically creates equipment models for connected devices that do not contain an equipment model (e.g., IOM **514**, third party controller **520**, etc.). For example, system manager **502** can create an equipment model for any device that responds to a device tree request. The equipment models created by system manager **502** can be stored within system manager **502**.

System manager **502** can then provide a user interface for devices that do not contain their own equipment models using the equipment models created by system manager **502**. In some embodiments, system manager **502** stores a view definition for each type of equipment connected via system bus **554** and uses the stored view definition to generate a user interface for the equipment.

(64) Each zone coordinator **506-510** and **518** can be connected with one or more of zone controllers **524**, **530-532**, **536**, and **548-550** via zone buses **556**, **558**, **560**, and **564**. Zone coordinators **506-510** and **518** can communicate with zone controllers **524**, **530-532**, **536**, and **548-550** via zone busses **556-560** and **564** using a MSTP protocol or any other communications protocol. Zone busses **556-560** and **564** can also connect zone coordinators **506-510** and **518** with other types of devices such as variable air volume (VAV) RTUs **522** and **540**, changeover bypass (COBP) RTUs **526** and **552**, bypass dampers **528** and **546**, and PEAK controllers **534** and **544**.

(65) Zone coordinators **506-510** and **518** can be configured to monitor and command various zoning systems. In some embodiments, each zone coordinator **506-510** and **518** monitors and commands a separate zoning system and is connected to the zoning system via a separate zone bus. For example, zone coordinator **506** can be connected to VAV RTU **522** and zone controller **524** via zone bus **556**. Zone coordinator **508** can be connected to COBP RTU **526**, bypass damper **528**, COBP zone controller **530**, and VAV zone controller **532** via zone bus **558**. Zone coordinator **510** can be connected to PEAK controller **534** and VAV zone controller **536** via zone bus **560**. Zone coordinator **518** can be connected to PEAK controller **544**, bypass damper **546**, COBP zone controller **548**, and VAV zone controller **550** via zone bus **564**.

(66) A single model of zone coordinator **506-510** and **518** can be configured to handle multiple different types of zoning systems (e.g., a VAV zoning system, a COBP zoning system, etc.). Each zoning system can include a RTU, one or more zone controllers, and/or a bypass damper. For example, zone coordinators **506** and **510** are shown as Verasys VAV engines (VVEs) connected to VAV RTUs **522** and **540**, respectively. Zone coordinator **506** is connected directly to VAV RTU **522** via zone bus **556**, whereas zone coordinator **510** is connected to a third-party VAV RTU **540** via a wired input **568** provided to PEAK controller **534**. Zone coordinators **508** and **518** are shown as Verasys COBP engines (VCEs) connected to COBP RTUs **526** and **552**, respectively. Zone coordinator **508** is connected directly to COBP RTU **526** via zone bus **558**, whereas zone coordinator **518** is connected to a third-party COBP RTU **552** via a wired input **570** provided to PEAK controller **544**.

(67) Zone controllers **524**, **530-532**, **536**, and **548-550** can communicate with individual BMS devices (e.g., sensors, actuators, etc.) via sensor/actuator (SA) busses. For example, VAV zone controller **536** is shown connected to networked sensors **538** via SA bus **566**. Zone controller **536** can communicate with networked sensors **538** using a MSTP protocol or any other communications protocol. Although only one SA bus **566** is shown in FIG. 5, it should be understood that each zone controller **524**, **530-532**, **536**, and **548-550** can be connected to a different SA bus. Each SA bus can connect a zone controller with various sensors (e.g., temperature sensors, humidity sensors, pressure sensors, light sensors, occupancy sensors, etc.), actuators (e.g., damper actuators, valve actuators, etc.) and/or other types of controllable equipment (e.g., chillers, heaters, fans, pumps, etc.).

(68) Each zone controller **524**, **530-532**, **536**, and **548-550** can be configured to monitor and control a different building zone. Zone controllers **524**, **530-532**, **536**, and **548-550** can use the inputs and outputs provided via their SA busses to monitor and control various building zones. For example, a zone controller **536** can use a temperature input received from networked sensors **538** via SA bus **566** (e.g., a measured temperature of a building zone) as feedback in a temperature control algorithm. Zone controllers **524**, **530-532**, **536**, and **548-550** can use various types of control algorithms (e.g., state-based algorithms, extremum seeking control (ESC) algorithms, proportional-integral (PI) control algorithms, proportional-integral-derivative (PID) control

algorithms, model predictive control (MPC) algorithms, feedback control algorithms, etc.) to control a variable state or condition (e.g., temperature, humidity, airflow, lighting, etc.) in or around building **10**.

(69) Equipment Control System and Edge Controller with Reinforcement Learning

(70) Referring now to FIGS. **6-7**, block diagrams of a control system **600** are shown, according to some embodiments. In some embodiments, the control system **600** is part of a building management system and/or includes components which are included in a building management system (e.g., BMS **400**, BMS **500**). As shown in FIG. **6**, the control system **600** includes an edge controller **602** communicable with one or more actuators **604**, one or more sensors and/or meters **606**, an occupancy system **608**, a weather service **610**, an active setpoint management service **612** (shown as part of BMS controller **366**), and a model creation computing system **614** (shown as including a simulator **616** and a model trainer **618**). In some embodiments, the model computing system **614**, the weather service **610**, the occupancy system **608** and/or one or more of the one or more sensors/meters **606** communicate with the edge controller **602** via the BMS controller **366** or other component of a building management system.

(71) In some embodiments, the control system **600** operates with or as part of the airside system **300** of FIG. **3**, for example. In such embodiments, the AHU controller **330** can be provided as the edge controller **602** (i.e., the edge controller **602** may be an embodiment of the AHU controller **330**) and the actuator(s) **604** can include the actuators **324**, **326**, **328** which operate the exhaust air damper **316**, mixing damper **318**, and outside air damper **320** of air handling unit **302**. The edge controller **602** can thereby control the air handling unit **302**, or at least one or more of the actuators **324**, **326**, **328** of the air handling unit **302**. In some embodiments, one or more of the actuators **324**, **326**, **328** is a smart actuator and the edge controller **602** is included as part of the smart actuator (e.g., in a same housing as the actuator, etc.). In various embodiments, the actuator(s) **604** may operate to control various dampers, valves, fans, compressors, etc. as suitable for control of corresponding types of equipment.

(72) In some embodiments, the control system **600** operates with or as part of the airside system **300** described with reference to FIG. **3**. For example, the sensors/meters **606** can include temperature sensors for measuring air temperature at various locations within the air handling unit **302** or upstream or downstream of the air handling unit **302**. For example, sensors/meters **606** may include the temperature sensor **362** arranged to measure the temperature of the supply air **310**, a temperature sensor **361** arranged to measure a mixed air temperature (i.e., the temperature of mixed air created by mixing the outside air **314** with the return air **304** downstream of the outside air damper **320** and the mixing damper **318**, which may be equivalent to the temperature of the air entering the fan **338** upstream of the heating coil **336** and the cooling coil **334**), etc. The sensors/meters **606** may also include the sensor **364** shown in FIG. **3** for measuring an indoor air temperature of a building zone **306**, a meter for measuring or estimating an amount of energy provided by and/or consumed by the cooling coil **334** and/or heating coil **336**, humidity sensors, airflow sensors, air quality sensors, etc.

(73) The edge controller **602** is configured to (e.g., programed to) control the actuator(s) **604** based on an indoor air temperature setpoint, state information from the sensor(s)/meter(s) **606**, and disturbance information from the weather service **610** and/or occupancy system **608** using an artificial intelligence algorithm, for example using a reinforcement learning model. As shown, the edge controller **602** can determine one or more internal control values for a unit of building equipment to be provided to actuator(s) **604**. For example, the edge controller **602** can determine a desired change in mixed air temperature for an air handling unit **302** (e.g., an amount by which the mixed air temperature should be changed from a current time step to a subsequent time step). The edge controller **602** and/or the AHU controller **330** can use the desired change in the mixed air temperature for controlling actuators **324-328** which operate dampers **316-320** of the air handling unit **302** to affect the mixed air temperature. The internal control value (e.g., the mixed air

temperature or the mixed air temperature setpoint) is distinct from the indoor air temperature setpoint for a building space (e.g., the temperature of the air within the building zone **306**) served by such equipment, the temperature of the supply air **310** discharged from the air handling unit **302**, or other building setpoint or target such as an amount of heat to be added/removed to the building space, a humidity setpoint for the building space, an air quality setpoint for the building space, etc. In some embodiments, the internal control value is a mixed air temperature, mixed air temperature setpoint, desired change in the mixed air temperature, or desired change in the mixed air temperature setpoint. In this context, the mixed air may be the air created by mixing or combining the return air **304** with the outside air **314** within the air handling unit **302**, before the mixed air is heated, cooled, humidified, dehumidified, or otherwise treated to generate the supply air **310** discharged from the air handling unit **302**, i.e., as measurable at temperature sensor **361** in FIG. 3. The edge controller **602** may be included with the unit of equipment, for example positioned inside the equipment, mounted on the equipment, distributed in a package with the unit of equipment, etc. The edge controller **602** may be coupled to and integrated with an actuator, a damper, a valve, etc. in various embodiments.

(74) As shown in FIG. 6, the edge controller **602** receives an indoor air temperature setpoint from active setpoint management service **612**. The active setpoint management service **612** can change the indoor air temperature setpoint over time, for example to ensure at least a certain degree of occupant comfort while reducing energy consumption, utility costs, carbon emissions, etc. The active setpoint management service **612** may output the indoor air temperature setpoint by performing a predictive optimization. The active setpoint management service **612** may set a schedule of temperature setpoints which vary over time, for example shifting energy load by pre-cooling or pre-heating a building space. In some embodiments, the active setpoint management service **612** uses model predictive control to generate the indoor air temperature setpoint, for example as described in U.S. Pat. No. 10,495,337, filed Apr. 28, 2017, the entire disclosure of which is incorporated by reference herein. In some embodiments, the active setpoint management service **612** is configured as a low-level airside controller as in U.S. Pat. No. 11,067,955, filed Jun. 30, 2016, the entire disclosure of which is incorporated by reference herein. The edge controller **602** can receive values of the indoor air temperature setpoint for multiple time steps (e.g., for a few hours ahead) and such that the indoor air temperature setpoint changes over time. The examples herein referring to indoor air temperature may be adapted for other states or conditions of a building, such as humidity, pressure, air quality, airflow, etc.

(75) In some systems in which a timeseries of temperature setpoints is optimized (e.g., by the active setpoint management service **612**), the equipment may attempt to track that setpoint in a non-optimal manner. In some examples, equipment is controlled using a reactive on/off approach where an equipment unit is turned on when a measured indoor temperature deviates from a setpoint and turns off when the measured indoor temperature is returned to the setpoint by operation of the equipment. As described in further detail below, the edge controller **602** can provide proactive control in anticipation of changes in indoor temperature which can reduce overall energy consumption of the equipment and improve how well an actual indoor temperature tracks the setpoint provided by the active setpoint management service **612** as compared to a reactive on/off control approach. Additional improvements to equipment operation are thereby provided by operation of the edge controller **602** as described herein, i.e., improvements beyond the efficiencies provided by active management of one or more building setpoints by the active setpoint management service **612**.

(76) The edge controller **602** is programmed to determine an action, shown as the internal control value in FIG. 6. In some embodiments, the action is denoted as $U_{sub.t}=u$ and is determined given the current state $X_{sub.t}=x$ based on a policy $\pi_{sub.\theta}$. Operations executed by the edge controller **602** in such embodiments can be expressed as: $u=\pi_{sub.\theta}(x)$ to determine the control action to take. In some embodiments, disturbances d are also inputs to the model, such that $u=\pi_{sub.\theta}(x, d)$. The

policy $\pi_{\text{sub}}\theta$ can be provided as an artificial intelligence model, for example a neural network model with parameters θ .

(77) Execution of action u via control of actuators **604** leads to a change in the state to $X_{\text{sub}.t+1}=x'$ based on the system dynamics (e.g., thermodynamics of a building space) and leads to a reward $R_{\text{sub}.t+1}=r$. The reward R may be based on an objective function (cost function), for example based on a deviation of a measured indoor temperature from the indoor temperature setpoint and/or an energy consumption of the equipment unit (e.g., $r=-C(x,u)$ with the reward representing a negative of cost C such that the reward r is maximized by the edge controller **602**). In such embodiments, the edge controller **602** can update the policy (model) parameters θ to θ^* by maximizing the expected reward (minimizing the objective or cost), e.g., $\theta^*=\text{argmax}_{\text{sub}}.\theta(r)$, thereby reinforcing learning embodied by the parameters of the model. In some embodiments, the parameters are updated using a proximal policy optimization approach, whereby the change in parameters is limited between consecutive updates to improve stability and robustness of the model.

(78) In the example of FIG. **6**, the policy (model) is created and initially trained at the model creation computing system **614**. The model creation computing system **614** may be separate from (e.g., remote from) the edge controller **602**. For example, the model creation computing system **614** may be provided via one or more servers, processors, databases, etc. of a cloud computing system. Accordingly, the model creation computing system **614** may be significantly more powerful and larger (e.g., more processing power and memory) as compared to the edge controller **602**, enabling operations to be performed at the model creation computing system **614** which are too extensive to be performed on the edge controller **602** in some embodiments.

(79) In some embodiments, the model creation computing system **614** creates the model and trains the model to imitate a controller operating in a simulation run by the model creation computing system **614**. For example, the model creation computing system **614** simulates building states, weather, equipment operation, etc., with a simulated controller generating simulated internal control values (actions) for simulated equipment. The simulation may be based on generic building modelling and simulation software and/or may be based on historical data specific to the building and/or equipment to be served by the edge controller **602**. For example, the model creation computing system **614** may use the EnergyPlus™ building energy simulation program funded by the U.S. Department of Energy. The simulation may require more computing power and/or memory than is available locally on the edge controller **602** in some embodiments.

(80) In some embodiments, the controller in the simulation is an ideal or optimal controller which operates the equipment at minimal possible value of the reward function (e.g., minimum cost, minimum deviation from indoor temperature setpoint, etc.). In some embodiments, the controller in the simulation is a model predictive controller running in the simulation to generate simulated control values based on an optimizing a predicted cost (and/or other objective) of simulated operation of the equipment in the simulation (e.g., given a variety of simulated weather, occupancy, and other conditions). For example, in an example where the edge controller **602** determines a mixed air temperature for controlling an air handling unit, the model creation computing system **614** can execute, within the simulation and using a model predictive control algorithm, a simulated mixed air temperatures which minimize a simulated objective associated with running a simulated air handling unit in the simulation.

(81) The model creation computing system **614** can train the model (RL model, artificial intelligence algorithm, policy, etc.) to replicate the behavior of the simulated controller, for example by selecting parameters which minimize differences between the outputs of the simulated controller under various input conditions and the outputs of the model under the same input conditions. The model is thereby trained to take system state and, in some embodiments, disturbance inputs and output an action (e.g., value for an internal control variable) which results in optimal behavior in the simulation, i.e., matching the output that would be provided by the

simulated controller.

(82) The model creation computing system **614** can then provide the trained model to the edge controller **602**. The model may be received the edge controller **602** in a sufficiently-trained state to initiate online operations of the edge controller **602**. The edge controller **602** may then perform reinforcement learning during online operations to fine-tune the model to actual building dynamics and to adjust the model overtime as building dynamics change (due to seasonal changes, space reconfigurations, utilization and occupancy changes, etc.). Pre-training the model offline and remote from the edge controller **602** can enable online operations prior to and early in such reinforcement learning and can ensure that reinforcement learning converges to and/or tracks an optimizing solution based on the behavior of the simulated controller (e.g., model predictive controller). The model is shown in FIG. 7 as the edge model **704**.

(83) The model creation computing system **614** can perform one or more operations to edge-ify the model, i.e., to reduce a size of the model, a required processing power for operating the model, or otherwise modify or adapt the model to enable the model to be transferred to the edge controller **602** and to be used locally on the edge controller **602** during online operations. The operations to edge-ify the model may make the model more lightweight or suitable for running on an edge device with limited computing power, as opposed to a centralized building management system controller or cloud-based controller with significantly more computing power or computational resources (e.g., more processor power, more memory, etc.). Configuration of the edge controller **602** which enables execution of the model and reinforcement learning operations on limited computing hardware is described in detail below with reference to FIG. 7.

(84) The occupancy system **608** is configured to provide information about occupancy a space served by the edge controller **602** (e.g., a space heated, cooled, or ventilated by equipment controlled by the edge controller **602**), for example an occupancy forecast. The occupancy forecast can indicate whether the space will be occupied at one or more upcoming times. In some embodiments, the occupancy forecast indicates a degree of occupation of the space expected at one or more upcoming times, for example a number of people expected to be in a space, an expected population density of a space, an expected ratio of number of people to maximum or target occupancy, etc. The occupancy forecast can be based on a schedule for a building (e.g., user-defined) and/or predictions based on historical occupancy data (e.g., as measured by occupancy sensors or an access/security system). The occupancy forecast can be used by the edge controller **602** in determining the internal control value for use in operating the actuators **604**. For example, the edge controller **602** may use the occupancy forecast as an disturbance input which allows the edge controller **602** to compensate for heat expected to be provided to the space by occupants (e.g., from occupant body heat). As another example, the edge controller **602** may use the occupancy forecast by ignoring or relaxing (e.g., increasing in cooling mode, decreasing in heating mode) the temperature setpoint from the active setpoint management service **612** during time steps where the space is forecast to be unoccupied.

(85) The weather service **610** is shown as providing a weather forecast to the edge controller **602**. In some embodiments, the weather forecast and the occupancy forecast combine to form a disturbance forecast provided to the edge controller **602** as shown in FIG. 7. The weather forecast can include values for weather-related variables such as outdoor air temperature, wind speed, wind direction, humidity, cloud cover, solar irradiance, precipitation rates or amounts, etc. The weather forecast can include values for such variables over an upcoming time period, for example a set of values for each hour of the next 12 hours, a set of values for each 15 minutes of the next three hours, etc. The weather service **610** can be publically or commercially-available meteorological service, for example a service of a government agency which makes weather forecasts available via the Internet.

(86) The sensors/meters **606**, the occupancy system **610**, the weather service **608**, and/or the BMS controller **366** combine to provide current state information and a disturbance forecast to the edge

controller **602**. In some embodiments, the current state includes one or more of the following variables: indoor air temperature setpoint, cooling setpoint, heating setpoint, coil power, HVAC power, actual indoor air temperature, occupant comfort rating (e.g., predicted mean vote, percent of persons with local discomfort), mixed air mass flow, mixed air temperature, outdoor air mass flow rate (e.g., into an air handling unit), outdoor air temperature, return air flow rate, return air temperature, supply air flow rate, supply air temperature, damper position(s), valve position(s), actuator status, fan speed, compressor speed, etc. In some embodiments, the disturbance forecast includes one or more of solar radiation (e.g., direct and/or diffused solar radiation), outdoor relative humidity, outdoor air temperature, wind direction, wind speed, and occupancy information.

(87) As shown in FIG. 7, the edge controller **602** includes protocol agents **701**. For example, the protocol agents can be programmed to normalize, translate, etc. data from multiple communication protocols as may be used by different sensors, meters, data sources, etc. into a common format. The protocol agents **701** can provide connection to the equipment **604**, sensor & meters **606**, occupancy system **610**, and weather forecast via standard protocols like BACNet, OPC-UA, MQTT, etc. using established protocol agents. The edge controller **602** also includes a software development kit (SDK) **703** which can be used if a connection needs to be made to a component which is not providing standard industry protocol interfaces, in which case the SDK **703** can be used to provide such interfaces. The protocol agents **701** and the SDK **703** can provide data on to a message bus **705** in a common format (e.g., BRICK, common data model).

(88) As shown in FIG. 7, the edge controller **602** includes an analytics engine **700** in an RL edge engine **702**. The analytics engine can execute logic in a functional programming language, for example, to provide pre-processing of data and perform feature generation from the various inputs that provide the state and disturbance information in various embodiments. The analytics engine **700** may perform interpolations, averages, extrapolations, etc. to fill a state or disturbance vector such that values are provided for all variables in a format suitable for input to an RL edge model **704** of the edge controller **602**. As another example, the analytics engine **700** can be programmed to synchronize data from the various data sources, such that data which may arrive or correspond to slightly different points in time can be aggregated into a vector or other format indicating values for a given time step. Other feature generation features in which the analytics engine **700** generates inputs for the RL edge model **704** based on state and disturbance information can be provided in various embodiments (e.g., pattern recognition, trend analysis, etc.). In some embodiments, the analytics engine **700** outputs a current state vector with current values of state variables (i.e., values associated with a current time step) and a matrix or set of vectors with forecast values of disturbance variables (e.g., twelve vectors or columns showing values for each fifteen minutes for the next three hours for the disturbance variables).

(89) The analytics engine **700** may provide such features (e.g., normalized, synchronized state and disturbance vectors) to the RL edge model **704**. The edge reinforcement learning engine **702** is configured to use the state and disturbance values from the analytics engine **700** to determine one or more control values for the actuator(s) **604** using the edge model **704** while updating the edge model **704** to reinforce learning of the edge model **704**, as further described in the following passages. The analytics engine **700** can act as a stream processing component which consumes input streams, process the corresponding data, and publishes results base as output streams to the message bus **705** with low latency and by acting on stream data without storing data.

(90) The edge model **704** may be an artificial intelligence model, for example a neural network or other machine learning (e.g., reinforcement learning) model. As discussed above, the edge model **704** may be created and initially trained on computing resources separate from the edge controller **602** (e.g., on model creation computing system **614**) and then provided in a trained state to the edge controller **602**, such that the edge model **704** shown part of the edge reinforcement learning engine **702** in FIG. 7 is pre-trained before use in online control of actuator(s) **604**.

(91) The edge model **704** may receive values of state and disturbance vectors as inputs (e.g., at

input nodes of a network model) and use such inputs to determine a control value for the one or more actuator(s) **604** (or other action), for example at an output node of the network model. In some embodiments, the control value is a setpoint for an internal condition of a unit of equipment, for example for a mixed air temperature of an air handling unit. In some embodiments, the control value is a change in an internal condition of the equipment to be achieved at a next time step, for example a change in mixed air temperature of an air handling unit (e.g., increase by u degrees, decrease by u degrees). The edge model **704** consumes input streams, runs the machine learning model with the data from the input streams, and publishes outputs to the message bus **705** where such outputs can be processed by the analytics engine **700** before being sent to equipment/actuator/etc. for control, in some embodiments.

(92) The message bus **705** is configured to receive the control value (or other action) from the edge model **704** (e.g., from an output node of the edge model **704**) and provide a control value or signal for the one or more actuator(s) **604**. The message bus **705** and the edge model **704** are enabled to operate on streams of data in some embodiments, thereby substantially eliminating latency in the control loop and reducing memory requirements. In some embodiments, the message bus **705** and/or the RL edge engine **702** may use various information to help control the actuator(s) **604** to achieve the control value determined by edge model **704**. For example, if the control value is a change in mixed air temperature, the message bus **705** and/or the RL edge engine **702** may use outdoor air temperature and return air temperature information to determine whether to increase the return air or increase the outside air by adjusting corresponding dampers in order to move the mixed air temperature in the direction indicated by the control value output from the edge model **704**. In some embodiments, the message bus **705** and/or the protocol agents **701** or SDK **703** translates the control value from the edge model **704** into a communications protocol used by the actuator(s) **604**. Various such functions for enabling control can be provided by the message bus **705** and/or other element of the edge controller **602** in various embodiments.

(93) The RL edge engine **702** operates to update the edge model **704**, in some embodiments updating one or more parameters of the edge model **704** at the same frequency at which control outputs are generated by the edge model **704** (e.g., at a same frequency that new state information is provided). The RL edge engine **702** may use a reward function that quantifies an amount of deviation of the actual indoor temperature served by equipment controlled by the edge controller **602** (with the actual indoor temperature affected by operation of such equipment) relative to the indoor temperature setpoint for the space. The reward function may also depend on other state information such as power consumed directly by the equipment (e.g., by a fan of an air handling unit, to drive motors of actuator(s) **604**, etc.) or indirectly at the equipment (e.g., energy transferred to air from a heating or cooling coil in an air handling unit), such that the reward function has energy-consumption-related information included in the reward function. In some embodiments, the edge model **704** is changing control variables based on a control policy valid for a current time step, which is continuously updated (i.e., at each time step) based on input vectors and current reward value, for example updated to maximize an accumulated reward and/or minimize an accumulated cost.

(94) The RL edge engine **702** can operate to determine adjustments to one or more parameters of the edge model **704** which optimize the reward function, for example subject to constraints which limit the amount by which a parameter can be changed from its current value. For example, the RL edge engine **702** can check whether a marginal change in parameter value would improve the value of the reward function (i.e., reduce deviation of temperature from setpoint, reduce energy consumption) and, if so, make the marginal change to the parameter value of the edge model **704** for use at subsequent time step. The edge model **704** is thereby repeatedly/constantly updated online and over time to locally reinforce learning initially performed remotely at the model creation computing system **614**. This reinforcement learning provides improved performance as time progresses, as illustrated in FIGS. **9-10** described below, and provides automated model

adjustments as changes to the space and/or equipment occur (e.g., different furniture, equipment degradation, utilization changes).

(95) FIG. 7 further illustrates that the message bus **705** can optionally provide current state, current disturbance, and current control data via data publication **710** to data storage **712**. Data storage **712** may be part of a building management system (e.g., at BMS controller **366** or connected database) or otherwise a separate device from the edge controller **602**. Collection of state, disturbance, and control information at data storage **712** may not be needed for online operation of the edge controller **602** (which can operate in real-time on streaming data without reference to stored data from earlier time steps), but may be useful for assessing performance, generating key performance indicators, future training of other models by the model creation computing system **614**, etc. FIGS. **9** and **10** provide graphs of example performance assessments that can be generated using stored data from data storage **712**, in some embodiments.

(96) Referring now to FIG. **8**, a flowchart of a process **850** which can be executed by the control system **600** is shown, according to some embodiments. Various features described above with reference to FIGS. **6-7** can be used in execution of process **850**.

(97) At step **852**, a model is trained at a computing system (e.g., model creation computing system **614**), for example by running a simulation (e.g., an EnergyPlus™ simulation) which includes an ideal or optimal controller. In such examples, training the model can include training the model to imitate operation of the ideal or optimal controller in the simulation. For example, the model may be trained to imitate operation of a simulated model predictive controller which runs in the simulation and generates simulated control values (e.g., mixed air temperature setpoints) which minimize an objective function under simulated conditions and simulated building dynamics. The model can thus be initiated in step **852** such that it can be expected to provide acceptable performance when initially brought online for control of building equipment.

(98) At step **854**, the model is transferred from the computing system on which it was trained in step **852** to an edge controller (e.g., edge controller **602**). The transfer can occur at a production facility (factory) or distribution center, in some embodiments. In some embodiments, the transfer occurs with the building equipment and the edge controller already installed at a specific building. For example, the transfer may occur over the Internet and/or over a building network (e.g., over a BACnet network, etc.). The trained model is thereby installed on the edge controller without needing to have been created or initially trained on the edge controller. In other embodiments, the edge controller interoperates with the separate computing system while the separate computing system runs a simulation to facilitate training of the edge controller in a coordinated manner, without requiring the edge controller to have sufficient computing power to itself run the simulation.

(99) At step **856**, a control value for an internal parameter of a unit of building equipment is generated by the edge controller using the model. Generating the edge controller using the model can include receiving state and disturbance information as inputs to the model and outputting the control value from the model, for example as described in detail above with reference to the edge controller **602**. The edge controller can use an indoor air temperature setpoint for a building space served by equipment controlled by the edge controller **602**, for example. In some embodiments, the control value is a mixed air temperature value, for example a setpoint for the mixed air temperature, a desired change in the mixed air temperature (e.g. relative to the current mixed air temperature, relative to the current mixed air temperature setpoint), etc.

(100) At step **858**, the unit of building equipment is operated in accordance with the control value. Step **858** can include controlling one or more actuators, for example to adjust one or more positions of one or more dampers or valves operated by such actuators. For example, step **858** can include controlling actuators **324**, **326**, **328** to operate dampers **316**, **318**, **320** as shown in FIG. **3**. Steps **852-858** thereby culminate in operation of tangible building equipment to physically affect a condition of the building equipment and/or the building.

(101) At step **860**, learning of the model is reinforced, for example based on a building setpoint and a corresponding measurement. The building setpoint may be an indoor air temperature setpoint and the corresponding measurement may be a measurement of the indoor air temperature. Reinforcing learning of the model can include adjusting one or more parameters of the model to improve a value of a reward function, for example where the reward function includes a term based on a difference between the building setpoint and the corresponding measurement. The reward function may also include a term based on energy usage of the equipment and/or a proxy for energy usage. For example, in some embodiments the control value can be used as a proxy for energy usage. Reinforcing learning of the model by adjusting parameters based on such a reward function can improve the model's ability over time to generate a control value which reduces error between the building setpoint and the corresponding measurement while also reducing energy usage or other objective. As illustrated in FIG. **8**, step **860** loops back to step **856**, such that the model is updated repeatedly, recursively, etc., for example each time that a control value is generated in step **856**.

(102) Referring now to FIG. **9**, a graphical view of model performance following initial (offline) training by the model creation computing system **614** is shown, according to some embodiments. FIG. **9** includes a first graph **800** of temperature values over time and a second graph **802** of control values over time. As shown the first graph **800**, offline, initial training enables the model to control equipment in a manner which causes indoor air temperature to substantially track the values achieved by the simulated expert control system (e.g., simulated model predictive controller). Deviation of temperature from the setpoint as shown in the graph can be indicative of lag time in reaching such temperatures due to system dynamics and attempts by the control approaches to save energy consumption or cost relative to approaches which more closely track the setpoints. As shown in the second graph **802**, the control values generated by the edge model may have some deviations from values generated by the simulated expert control system, while imitating an overall shape of such values over time.

(103) Referring now to FIG. **10**, a graphical view (including third graph **900** and fourth graph **902**) of model performance while reinforcement learning is in progress at the edge controller **602** is shown, according to some embodiments. In particular, FIG. **10** shows data for an initial period following initiation of online operation of the edge controller **602**. As shown in the third graph **900** of indoor air temperature over time, the temperature resulting from operation of the edge controller **602** and use of the edge model **604** tracks closely with the temperature that would result from an ideal, expert, simulated control system. As shown in the fourth graph **902** of control values over time, the control value determined by the edge model has deviations from an expert simulated control value at the beginning of reinforcement learning but converges over time such that, towards the right end of the graph (later in time), performance of the edge model substantially imitates performance of a theoretical/ideal (e.g., simulated) expert control approach.

(104) By tracking the expert, idealized approach, experimental data as shown in FIG. **10** indicates that energy requirements (e.g., heating demand) for operation of HVAC equipment can be significantly reduced by operation of the edge model with reinforcement learning as described herein (e.g., from 43709 kW for conventional approach to 24901 kW for the approach described herein, in one example). Further, providing such advanced control at the edge (e.g., locally onboard equipment) allows such advantages to be achieved under intermittent connectivity, at potentially reduced bandwidths (as full state data need not be upload to a remote resources for use in optimization algorithms), less networking complexity, and lower computing hardware requirements. Various improvements to equipment performance and control architecture are thus provided by the technologies described herein.

CONFIGURATION OF EXEMPLARY EMBODIMENTS

(105) The construction and arrangement of the systems and methods as shown in the various exemplary embodiments are illustrative only. Although only a few embodiments have been described in detail in this disclosure, many modifications are possible (e.g., variations in sizes,

dimensions, structures, shapes and proportions of the various elements, values of parameters, mounting arrangements, use of materials, colors, orientations, etc.). For example, the position of elements may be reversed or otherwise varied and the nature or number of discrete elements or positions may be altered or varied. Accordingly, all such modifications are intended to be included within the scope of the present disclosure. The order or sequence of any process or method steps may be varied or re-sequenced according to alternative embodiments. Other substitutions, modifications, changes, and omissions may be made in the design, operating conditions and arrangement of the exemplary embodiments without departing from the scope of the present disclosure.

(106) The present disclosure contemplates methods, systems and program products on any machine-readable media for accomplishing various operations. The embodiments of the present disclosure may be implemented using existing computer processors, or by a special purpose computer processor for an appropriate system, incorporated for this or another purpose, or by a hardwired system. Embodiments within the scope of the present disclosure include program products including machine-readable media for carrying or having machine-executable instructions or data structures stored thereon. Such machine-readable media can be any available media that can be accessed by a general purpose or special purpose computer or other machine with a processor. By way of example, such machine-readable media can comprise RAM, ROM, EPROM, EEPROM, CD-ROM or other optical disk storage, magnetic disk storage or other magnetic storage devices, or any other medium which can be used to carry or store desired program code in the form of machine-executable instructions or data structures and which can be accessed by a general purpose or special purpose computer or other machine with a processor. When information is transferred or provided over a network or another communications connection (either hardwired, wireless, or a combination of hardwired or wireless) to a machine, the machine properly views the connection as a machine-readable medium. Thus, any such connection is properly termed a machine-readable medium. Combinations of the above are also included within the scope of machine-readable media. Machine-executable instructions include, for example, instructions and data which cause a general purpose computer, special purpose computer, or special purpose processing machines to perform a certain function or group of functions.

(107) Although the figures show a specific order of method steps, the order of the steps may differ from what is depicted. Also two or more steps may be performed concurrently or with partial concurrence. Such variation will depend on the software and hardware systems chosen and on designer choice. All such variations are within the scope of the disclosure. Likewise, software implementations could be accomplished with standard programming techniques with rule Based logic and other logic to accomplish the various connection steps, processing steps, comparison steps and decision step.

Claims

1. A method comprising: training a reinforcement learning model to replicate outputs of a model predictive control algorithm running in a simulation, the model predictive control algorithm determining simulated mixed air temperatures which minimize an objective associated with running a simulated air handling unit in the simulation; generating a mixed air temperature value using the reinforcement learning model running on an edge controller, wherein an indoor air temperature setpoint and a weather forecast are inputs to the reinforcement learning model; and controlling damper positions of an air handling unit to achieve the mixed air temperature value.
2. The method of claim 1, further comprising automatically updating, by the edge controller, the reinforcement learning model based on a reward function comprising a difference between the indoor air temperature setpoint and a measured indoor air temperature.
3. The method of claim 2, wherein the reward function is further based on an occupancy of a space

served by the air handling unit.

4. The method of claim 1, wherein using the reinforcement learning model comprises performing feature generation on streaming input data based on logic in a functional programming language and using variables resulting from the feature generation as further inputs to the reinforcement learning model.

5. The method of claim 1, wherein generating the mixed air temperature value using the reinforcement learning model running on the edge controller further comprises processing streams of building and equipment state information at the edge controller.

6. The method of claim 1, further comprising: creating the reinforcement learning model on a computing system separate from the edge controller; and transferring the reinforcement learning model from the computing system to the edge controller after the creating.

7. The method of claim 1, wherein the inputs to the reinforcement learning model further comprise an occupancy forecast.

8. An air handling unit, comprising: a plurality of dampers; a local controller programmed to control the plurality of dampers by: generating a mixed air temperature value using a reinforcement learning model running on the local controller, wherein a temperature setpoint and a weather forecast are inputs to the reinforcement learning model, wherein the reinforcement learning model is trained to replicate simulated mixed air temperatures output by a model predictive control algorithm running in a simulation, the model predictive control algorithm determining simulated mixed air temperatures which minimize an objective associated with running a simulated air handling unit in the simulation; and controlling damper positions of the air handling unit to achieve the mixed air temperature value.

9. The air handling unit of claim 8, wherein the local controller is further programmed to automatically update the reinforcement learning model using reinforcement learning based on a difference between an indoor temperature setpoint for a building served by the air handling unit and a measurement of the indoor temperature setpoint.

10. The air handling unit of claim 9, wherein the mixed air temperature value is a change in mixed air temperature of the air handling unit to be achieved by controlling the damper positions and the indoor temperature setpoint is a value to be achieved for a building and received by the local controller from an active setpoint management service.

11. The air handling unit of claim 8, wherein the local controller is further programmed to automatically update the reinforcement learning model using a reward function comprising a difference between one of the inputs to the reinforcement learning and a measurement of a measured condition of a space served by the air handling unit.

12. The air handling unit of claim 8, the local controller is programed to perform feature generation on streaming input data based on logic in a functional programming language and to use variables resulting from the feature generation as further inputs to the reinforcement learning model.

13. The air handling unit of claim 8, wherein generating the mixed air temperature value using the reinforcement learning model running on the local controller further comprises processing streams of building and equipment state information at the local controller.

14. The air handling unit of claim 8, wherein the local controller is further programmed to apply an occupancy forecast as an input to the reinforcement learning model.

15. The air handling unit of claim 8, wherein the temperature setpoint is an indoor air temperature setpoint in units of degrees.
